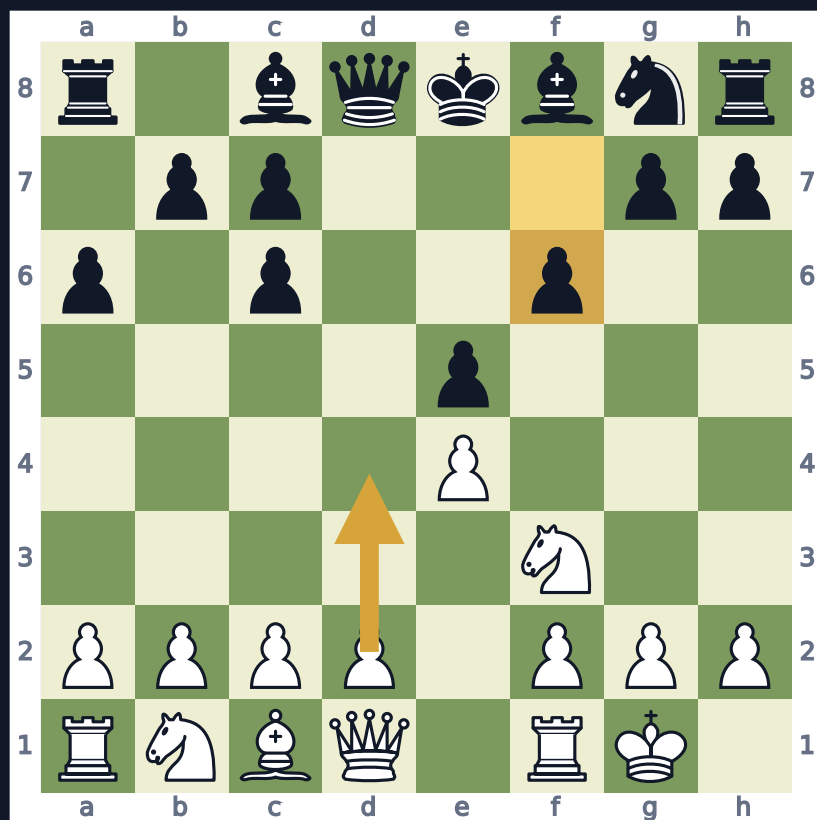


15

The Exchange Variation

Bishop pair versus pawn structure, the famous king-and-pawn ending, and active middlegame play.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will know why White exchanges on c6, why Black accepts it, and which simplifications favor each side.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate candidates for the side to move, identify the opponent's strongest resource, and choose the resulting structure you can explain. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 085 | PAGE 4

Decode: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop

The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

LESSON 086 | PAGE 8

Play: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop

The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

LESSON 087 | PAGE 12

Decode: Black's ...f6 support

A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.

LESSON 088 | PAGE 16

Play: Black's ...f6 support

A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.

LESSON 089 | PAGE 20

Decode: The pawn-ending warning

Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

LESSON 090 | PAGE 24

Play: The pawn-ending warning

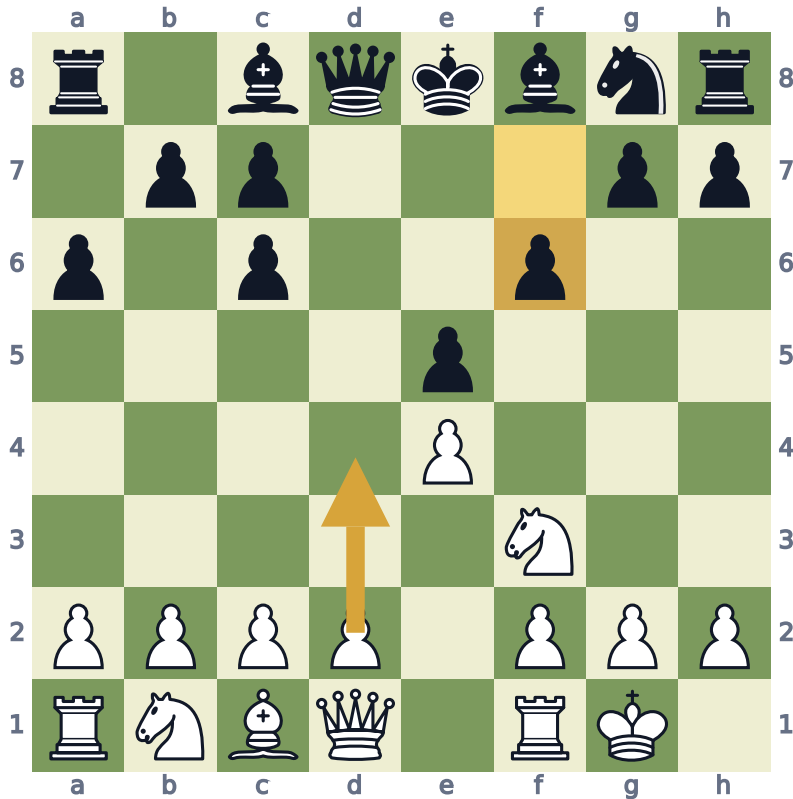
Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

VOLUME OBJECTIVE

You will know why White exchanges on c6, why Black accepts it, and which simplifications favor each side.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending.

DECISION RULE

Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Black uses the bishops, central pawns, and open lines before the damaged majority becomes an endgame liability.

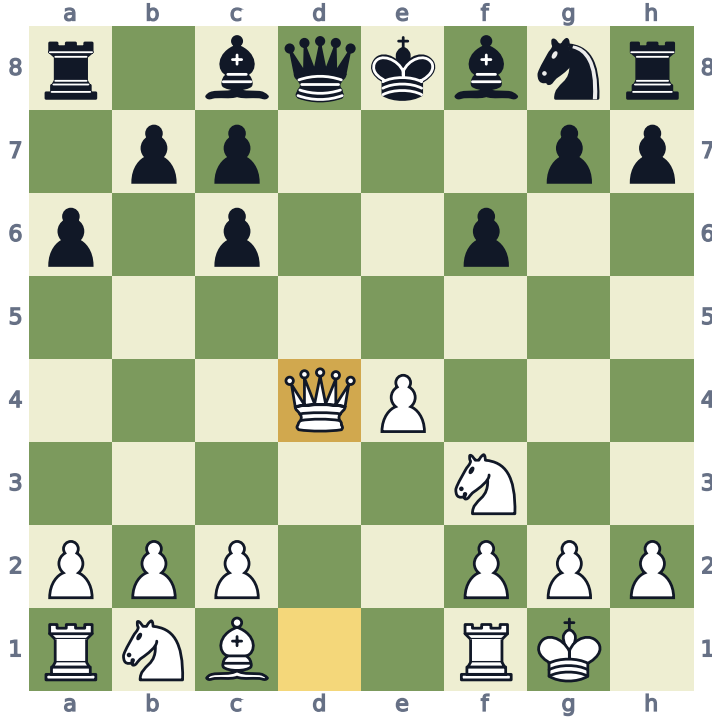
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops.

MEMORY RULE | The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending.

BLACK'S PLAN

Black uses the bishops, central pawns, and open lines before the damaged majority becomes an endgame liability.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops.

FAILURE MODE

White trading every piece regardless of bishop activity, or Black accepting passive simplification.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

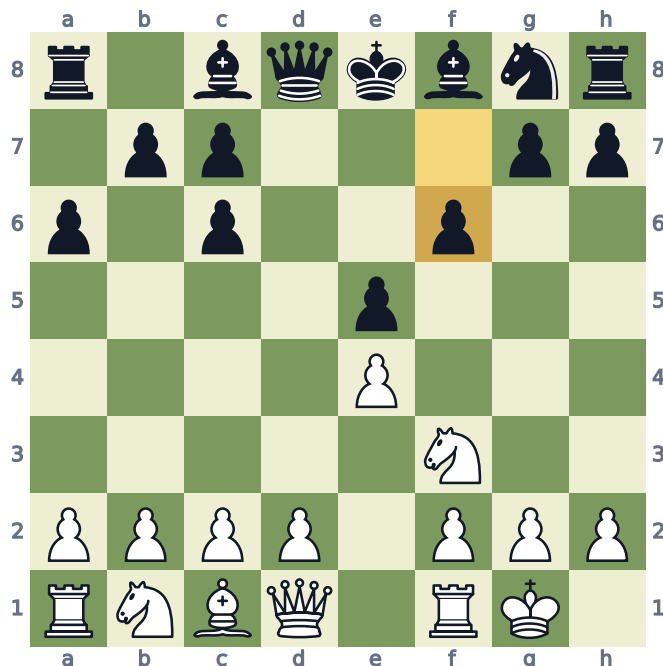
RULE | The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4



- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- a6: Black questions the b5 bishop and asks White to choose tension or structural damage.
- Bxc6: White releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- dxc6: Black releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- f6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much? White's resource is: White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops. The line fails as a template when: White trading every piece regardless of bishop activity, or Black accepting passive simplification.

STORE THIS | The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

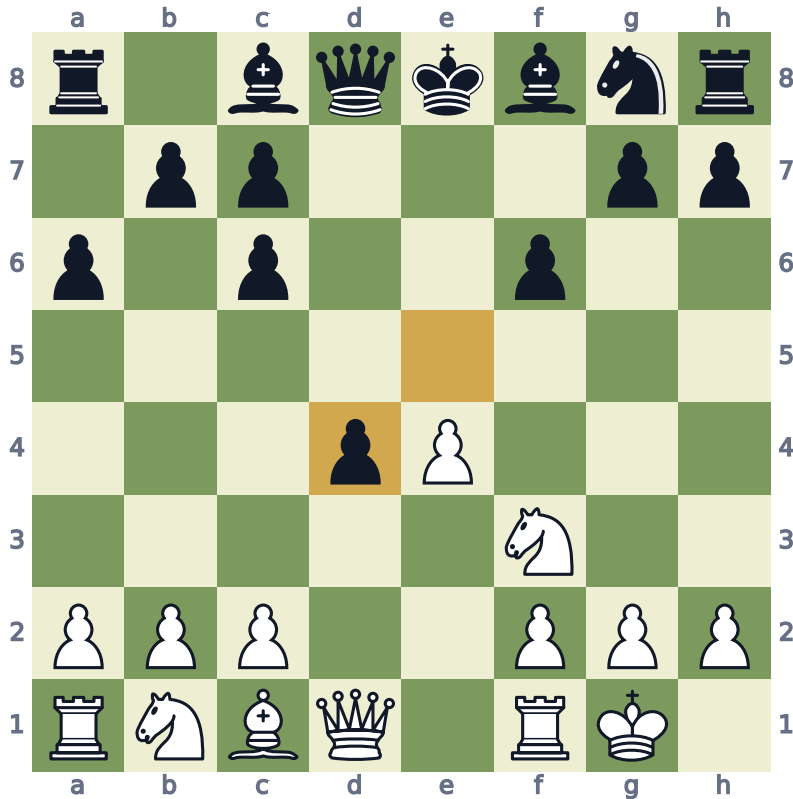
1. White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending. 2. Black uses the bishops, central pawns, and open lines before the damaged majority becomes an endgame liability. 3. White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops. 4. Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much? 5. White trading every piece regardless of bishop activity, or Black accepting passive simplification.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending.

DECISION RULE

Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Black uses the bishops, central pawns, and open lines before the damaged majority becomes an endgame liability.

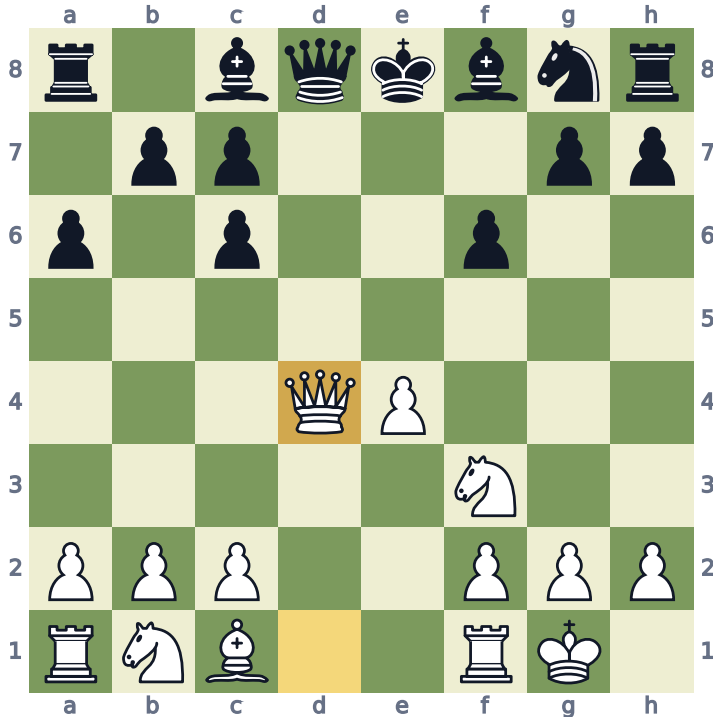
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops.

MEMORY RULE | The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending.

BLACK'S PLAN

Black uses the bishops, central pawns, and open lines before the damaged majority becomes an endgame liability.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S PLAN

White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops.

FAILURE MODE

White trading every piece regardless of bishop activity, or Black accepting passive simplification.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

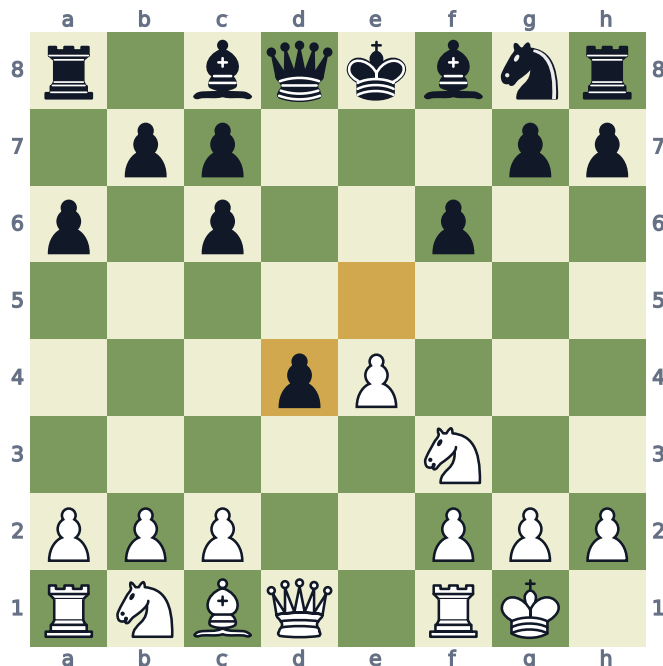
RULE | The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4



- Bxc6: White releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- dxc6: Black releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- f6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- exd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

White surrenders the bishop pair to damage Black's queenside majority and create a favorable long-term pawn ending.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much? White's resource is: White simplifies selectively, creates a kingside majority, and limits the bishops. The line fails as a template when: White trading every piece regardless of bishop activity, or Black accepting passive simplification.

STORE THIS | The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

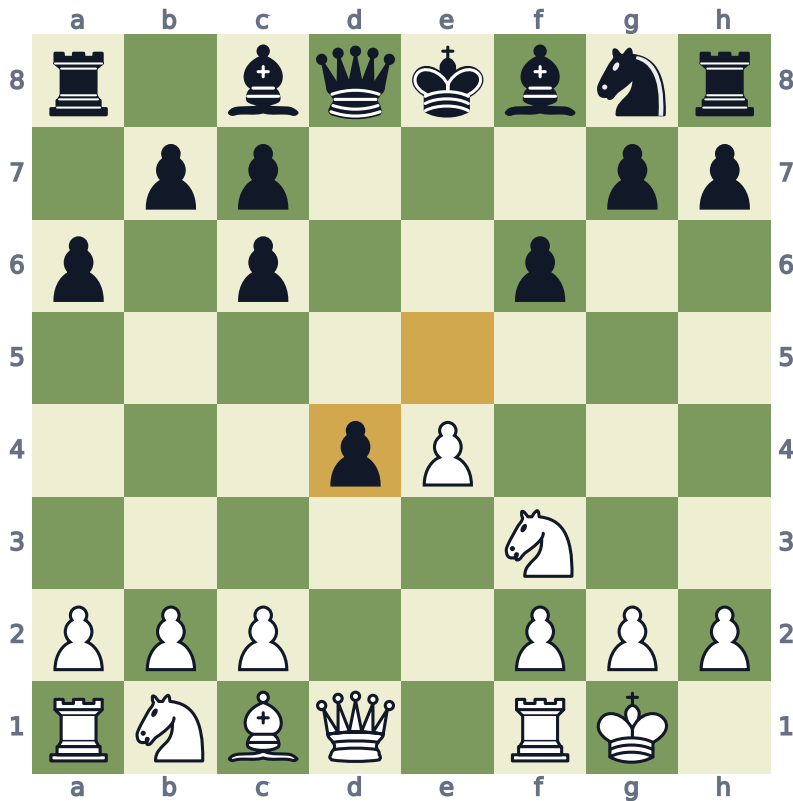
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Black's ...f6 support



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...f6 supports e5 and prepares king activity, but it blocks the g8 knight's best square and slightly loosens the king.

DECISION RULE

Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Develop through e7 or h6, use the bishop pair, and avoid letting f6 become a permanent hook.

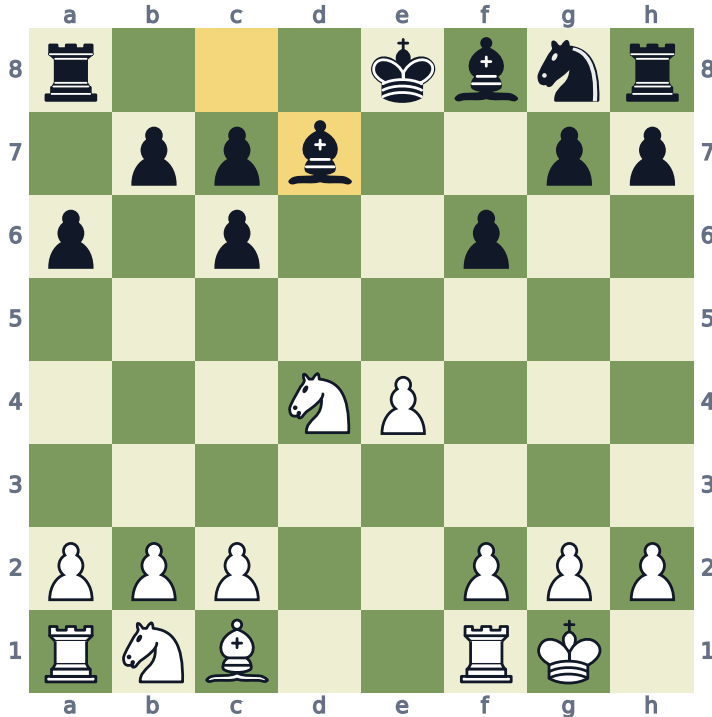
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens the center while Black's kingside development is awkward and seeks exchanges.

MEMORY RULE | A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...f6 supports e5 and prepares king activity, but it blocks the g8 knight's best square and slightly loosens the king.

BLACK'S PLAN

Develop through e7 or h6, use the bishop pair, and avoid letting f6 become a permanent hook.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the center while Black's kingside development is awkward and seeks exchanges.

FAILURE MODE

Protecting e5 so heavily that the kingside pieces never become active.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

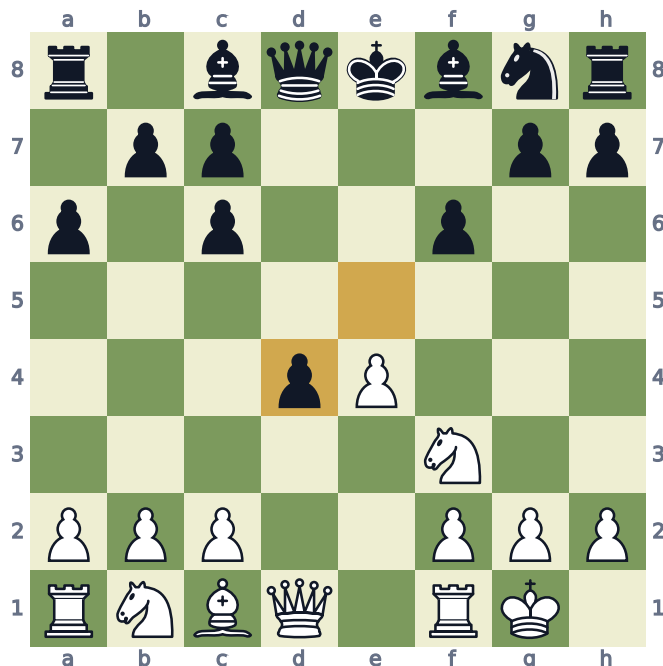
RULE | A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7



- Bxc6: White releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- dxc6: Black releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- f6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...f6 supports e5 and prepares king activity, but it blocks the g8 knight's best square and slightly loosens the king.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6? White's resource is: White opens the center while Black's kingside development is awkward and seeks exchanges. The line fails as a template when: Protecting e5 so heavily that the kingside pieces never become active.

STORE THIS | A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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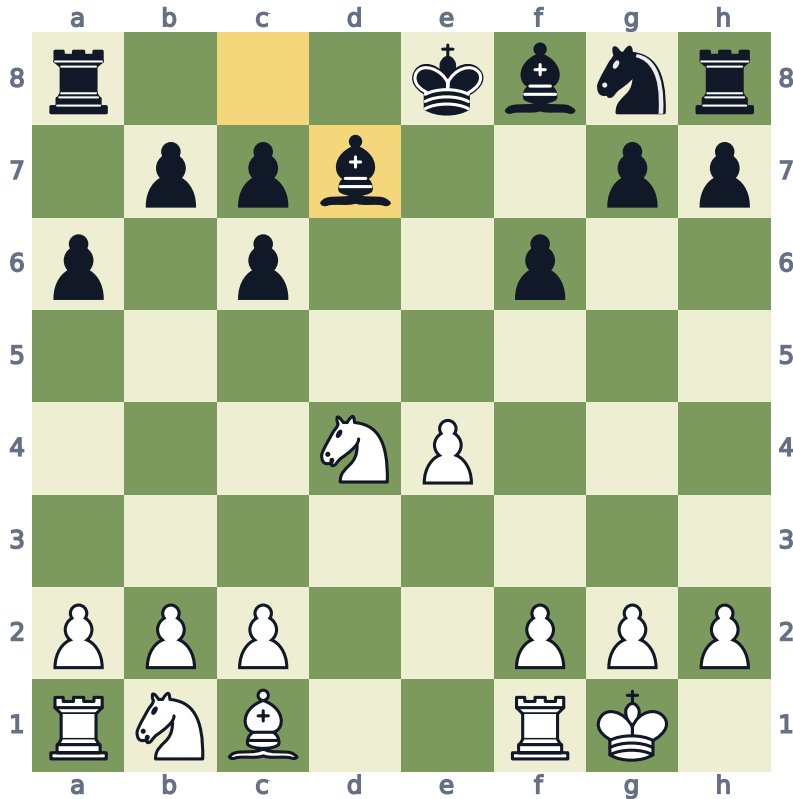
1. ...f6 supports e5 and prepares king activity, but it blocks the g8 knight's best square and slightly loosens the king. 2. Develop through e7 or h6, use the bishop pair, and avoid letting f6 become a permanent hook. 3. White opens the center while Black's kingside development is awkward and seeks exchanges. 4. Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6? 5. Protecting e5 so heavily that the kingside pieces never become active.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Black's ...f6 support



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...f6 supports e5 and prepares king activity, but it blocks the g8 knight's best square and slightly loosens the king.

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SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

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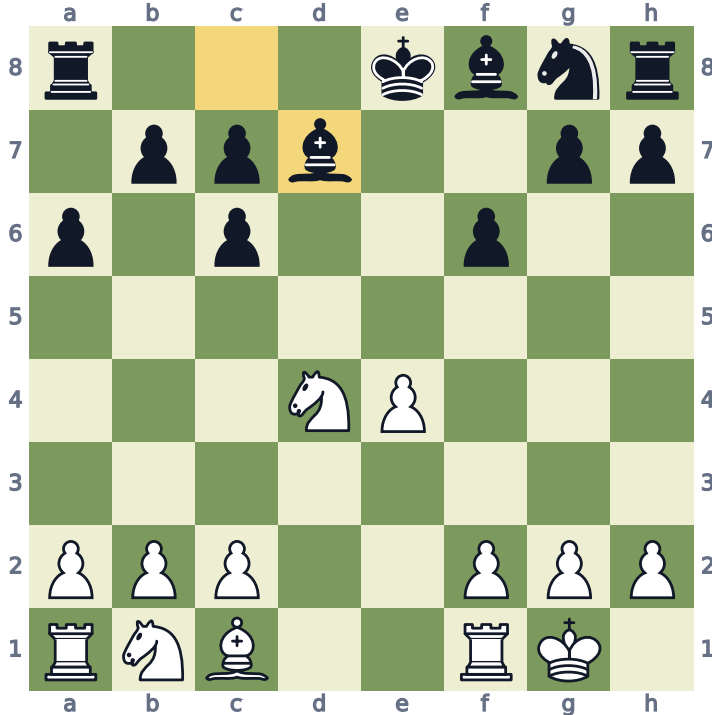
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

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BLACK'S PLAN

Develop through e7 or h6, use the bishop pair, and avoid letting f6 become a permanent hook.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the center while Black's kingside development is awkward and seeks exchanges.

FAILURE MODE

Protecting e5 so heavily that the kingside pieces never become active.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

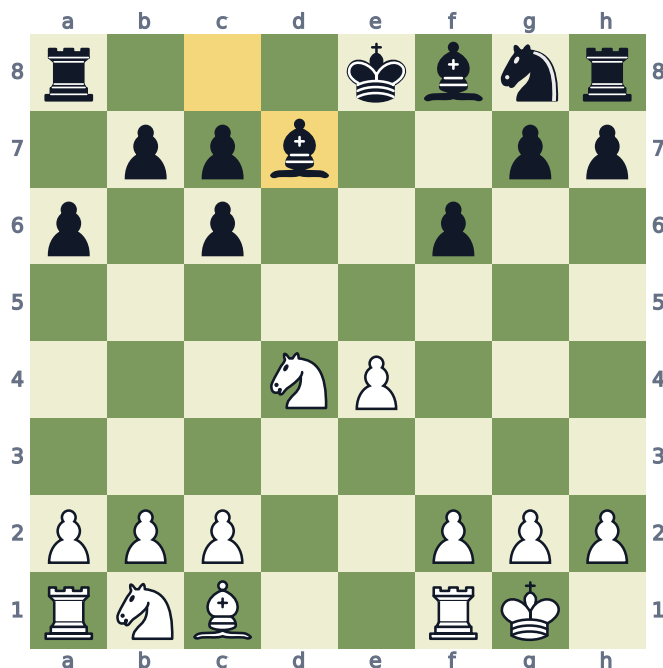
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7



- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- exd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...f6 supports e5 and prepares king activity, but it blocks the g8 knight's best square and slightly loosens the king.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6? White's resource is: White opens the center while Black's kingside development is awkward and seeks exchanges. The line fails as a template when: Protecting e5 so heavily that the kingside pieces never become active.

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COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

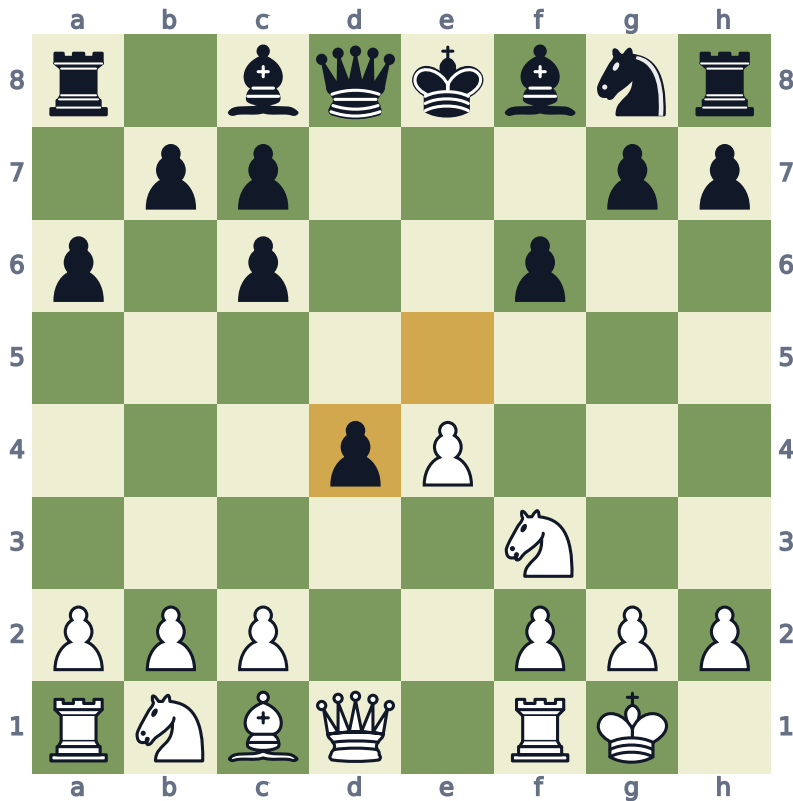
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The pawn-ending warning



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one.

DECISION RULE

After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Keep active pieces, create counterplay, and exchange into pawn endings only after calculating the majority race.

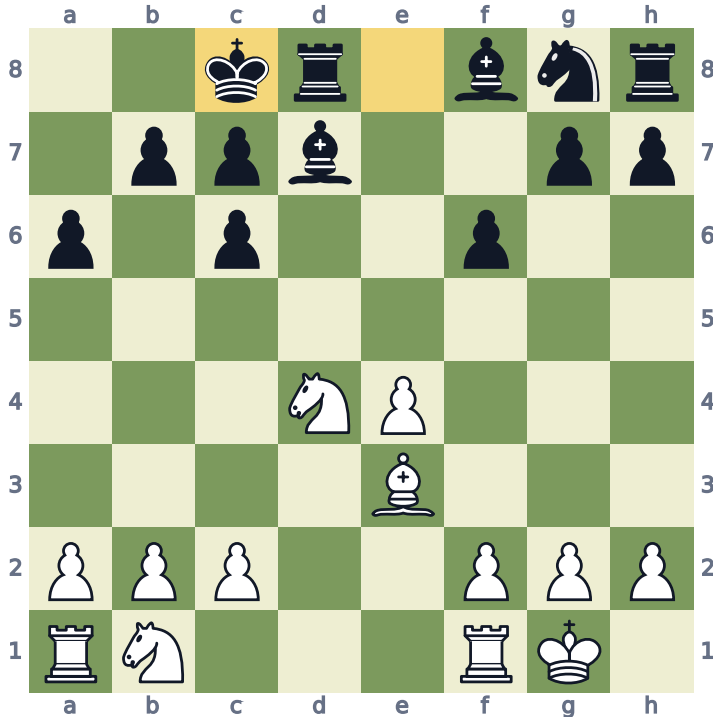
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority.

MEMORY RULE | Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one.

BLACK'S PLAN

Keep active pieces, create counterplay, and exchange into pawn endings only after calculating the majority race.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority.

FAILURE MODE

Calling a queenless or rookless ending equal without calculating the pawn majorities.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

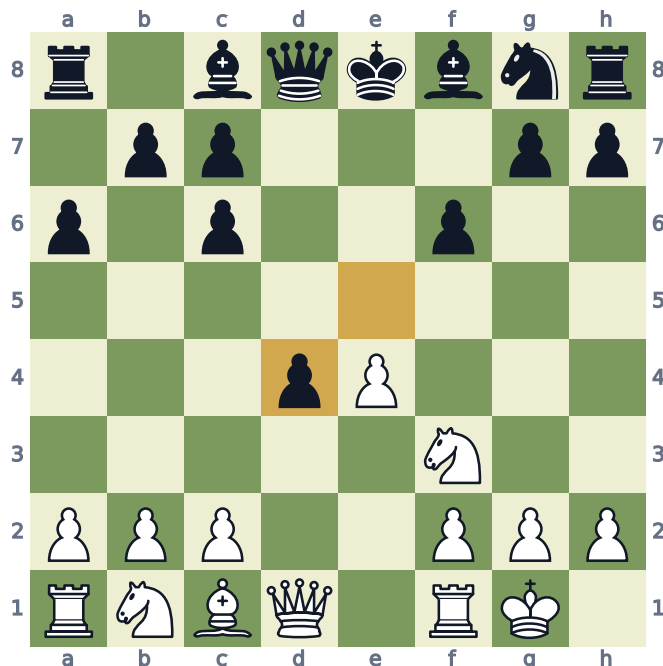
RULE | Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7 9. Be3 O-O-O



- Bxc6: White releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- dxc6: Black releases tension by capturing on c6; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- f6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
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WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first? White's resource is: White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority. The line fails as a template when: Calling a queenless or rookless ending equal without calculating the pawn majorities.

STORE THIS | Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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ANSWER KEY

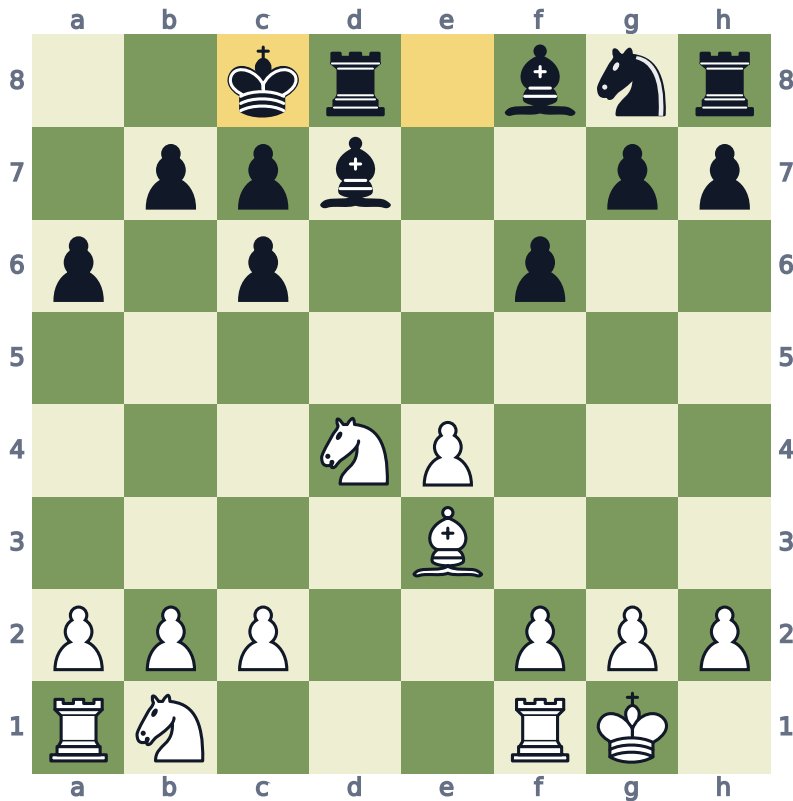
1. If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one. 2. Keep active pieces, create counterplay, and exchange into pawn endings only after calculating the majority race. 3. White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority. 4. After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first? 5. Calling a queenless or rookless ending equal without calculating the pawn majorities.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The pawn-ending warning



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one.

DECISION RULE

After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

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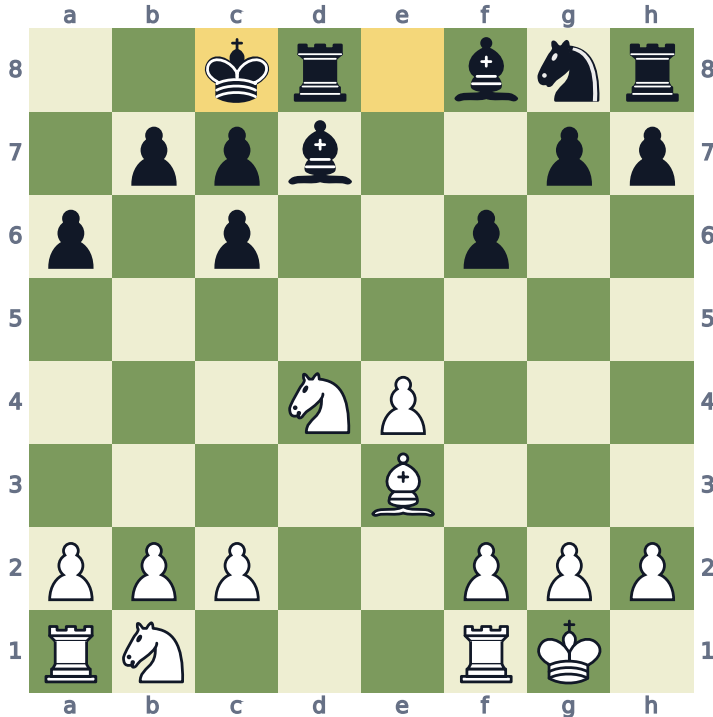
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority.

MEMORY RULE | Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one.

BLACK'S PLAN

Keep active pieces, create counterplay, and exchange into pawn endings only after calculating the majority race.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority.

FAILURE MODE

Calling a queenless or rookless ending equal without calculating the pawn majorities.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

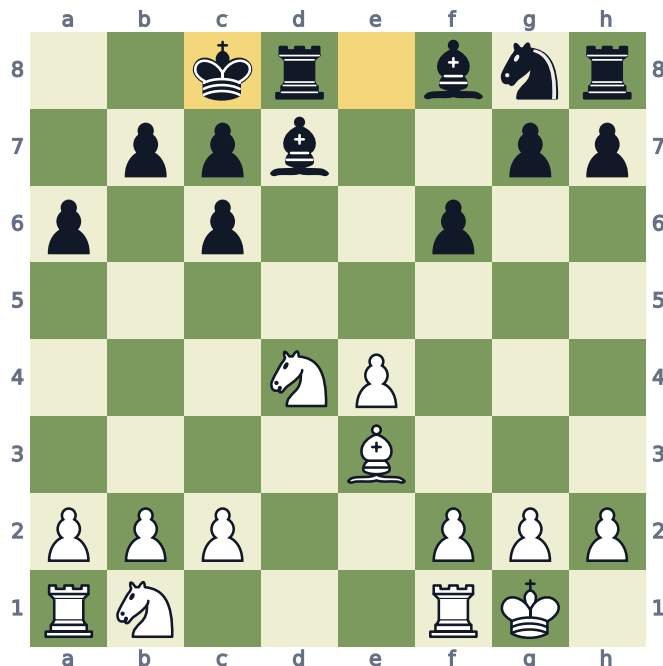
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7 9. Be3 O-O-O



- Qxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Bd7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Be3: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- O-O-O: Black secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first? White's resource is: White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority. The line fails as a template when: Calling a queenless or rookless ending equal without calculating the pawn majorities.

STORE THIS | Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. If all pieces disappear, White can often create a passed pawn with the kingside majority while Black's doubled c-pawns fail to make one. 2. Keep active pieces, create counterplay, and exchange into pawn endings only after calculating the majority race. 3. White welcomes piece trades that preserve a healthy kingside four-against-three majority. 4. After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first? 5. Calling a queenless or rookless ending equal without calculating the pawn majorities.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7 9. Be3 O-O-O

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 085 Decode: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop

Prompt: Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much?

Recall: *The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.*

LESSON 086 Play: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop

Prompt: Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much?

Recall: *The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.*

LESSON 087 Decode: Black's ...f6 support

Prompt: Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6?

Recall: *A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.*

LESSON 088 Play: Black's ...f6 support

Prompt: Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6?

Recall: *A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.*

LESSON 089 Decode: The pawn-ending warning

Prompt: After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first?

Recall: *Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.*

LESSON 090 Play: The pawn-ending warning

Prompt: After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first?

Recall: *Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.*

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's plan, one candidate for the side to move, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Why White gives up the Spanish bishop

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4

Decision: Does this exchange approach the favorable pawn ending or activate Black's bishops too much?

Memory: The Exchange Spanish is a time race: bishops now versus structure later.

CARD 2

Black's ...f6 support

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7

Decision: Which route develops the g8 knight and king most efficiently after ...f6?

Memory: A pawn that supports the center must not imprison the pieces behind it.

CARD 3

The pawn-ending warning

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 a6 4. Bxc6 dxc6 5. O-O f6 6. d4 exd4 7. Qxd4 Qxd4 8. Nxd4 Bd7 9. Be3 O-O-O

Decision: After all exchanges, can each wing create a passed pawn and whose king reaches it first?

Memory: Before simplifying, play the pawn ending in your head.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
085 Decode: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
086 Play: Why White gives up the Spanish bishop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
087 Decode: Black's ...f6 support	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
088 Play: Black's ...f6 support	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
089 Decode: The pawn-ending warning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
090 Play: The pawn-ending warning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name both sides' strongest plans, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.